STATEMENT OF WORK

BUREAU OF ALCOHOL, TOBACCO, FIREARMS AND EXPLOSIVES

NATIONAL CENTER FOR EXPLOSIVES TRAINING AND RESEARCH

EXPLOSIVES SPECIALIST (CLIN 0001)
FIRE / ARSON SPECIALIST (CLIN 0002)
EXERCISE SUPPORT SPECIALIST (CLIN 0003)
TECHNICAL OPERATIONS SPECIALIST (CLIN 0004)
ACADEMY CANINE TRAINER (CLIN 0005)
NORT CANINE TRAINER (CLIN 0006)

October 7, 2026

STATEMENT OF WORK

1.0 OVERVIEW

The Bureau of Alcohol Tobacco, Firearms and Explosives (ATF), National Center for Explosives Training and Research (NCETR) is issuing this Statement of Work (SOW) for Explosives Specialist, Fire / Arson Specialist, Exercise Support Specialist, Technical Operations Specialist, Academy Canine Trainer and NORT Canine Trainer, (herein referred to as "Contractor") with the intent to issue multiple Blanket Purchase Agreements (BPA) with fixed daily rates. ATF anticipates opportunities to provide services will be rotated among successful contractors after consideration of availability, rates, geographic location and positive performance ratings.

Once a contractor has been awarded a BPA, ATF is not obligated to select that contractor to provide services for a specific course or to continue to use a contractor following BPA award. The selection of a contractor under the BPA is within ATF's discretion and authority and is not subject to protest or dispute procedures.

Under this agreement, ATF may use the negotiated rates to apply to actual service time or for time spent developing content for new or updated training. It is not the intent of this agreement to procure the services of placement companies with a pool of available instructors. BPAs will be awarded on a one-to-one, individual basis.

In support of ATF's Strategic Plan and mission objectives, NCETR is dedicated to supporting ATF personnel, law enforcement, military, and industry partners through the dissemination of ATF's unique knowledge and expertise to prevent terrorism, reduce violent crime, and protect the public. NCETR's training mission is to:

1. Assess, design, deliver and evaluate innovative training programs,
2. Facilitate a creative learning environment that fosters continuous learner development, and
3. Create an adaptable workforce capable of meeting current and future mission requirements.

2.0 SCOPE

ATF has a number of responsibilities with regard to the assessment, development, delivery, and evaluation of training programs and is seeking to obtain contractors to further support their training and capabilities exercise efforts. ATF delivers a number of law enforcement related topics, at multiple locations, to a variety of students including Federal, State and local law enforcement personnel, ATF industry operations, military personnel, federal government civilians, and other public safety related personnel. Program Managers must maintain the ability to update and change curricula on a regular basis, so the requirements for specific skills sets and the frequency of their use may vary greatly depending on current staffing levels and types of courses or exercises being offered.

3.0 CONTRACTOR REQUIREMENTS

Contractors acknowledge meeting the following minimum qualifications upon proposal submission:

1. Contractors:

    a. Must be able to travel to the training/exercise site as dictated by the agreement. This may involve travel domestically or internationally depending on the program.
    b. Must have a flexible work schedule that meets the needs of the training/exercise being provided or developed.
    c. Must be able to pass a background investigation as required by the training program or training facility (s*ee section 3.4 for more information)*.
    d. Must have and maintain an active registration in SAM.gov.
    e. Must be willing to volunteer for random drug testing.
    f. Must have access to the internet and maintain a working email address for access to required on-line applications and to receive contractor notifications and announcements.

2. Contractors must not have been:

    a. Convicted of a felony offense.
    b. Convicted for an offense involving violence against a law enforcement officer.
    c. Convicted for an offense involving rape, child brutality, or child molestation.
    d. Convicted for an offense of either drug or firearms sales or trafficking activities.
    e. Convicted for an offense that, if revealed, would reflect poorly upon the Federal Government or would otherwise present a threat to the safety and security of employees.
    f. Must not be currently subject to disciplinary action by an employer, released from a position as a result of a disciplinary action, or have resigned from a position prior to the culmination of a disciplinary investigation.
    g. Must not be a prohibited person in regards to explosives usage and possession as per Federal statutes.
    h. Must not be a prohibited person in regards to possessing and transferring firearms as per Federal statutes.

3. Contractors must be able to demonstrate professional behavior and expertise that meet ATF and the National Center for Explosives Training and Research standards.

4. Explosives Instructors (CLIN 0001), Fire/Arson Instructors (CLIN 0002), Canine Trainers for the Academy (CLIN 0005) and NORT (CLIN 0006) must come prepared to provide training, which includes being intimately familiar with the lesson plan, its requirements and instructional strategies, lesson materials, safety instructions where applicable, and evaluation requirements.

5. Exercise Support Specialists (CLIN 0003) and Technical Operations Specialists (CLIN 0004) must come prepared to provide exercise support, which includes being intimately familiar with the scenarios. Specialists must also be prepared to assist in all aspects of the exercise from set-up to tear-down and packing for the next venue.

6. Canine Trainers for the Academy (CLIN 0005) and NORT (CLIN 0006) must be capable of the following physical requirements:

    a. Perform moderate degree of physical exertion 75% of the time, and
    b. ability to lift up to 120lbs, and
    c. walk for extended periods on rocky, slippery, and uneven surfaces, standing/bending frequently
    d. cleaning up after canines, kennels, training sites and vehicles.

7. Contractors must meet ATF evaluation requirements for position specific expertise while providing services. ATF staff will regularly evaluate contractor's skills, adherence to stated objectives, and adherence to any safety requirements.

8. Contractors must report to the appropriate point of contact as required by the reporting instructions.

9. Contractors must follow security protocols for handling and securing sensitive documentation and access to ATF facilities. Facility security requirements may be site specific.

10. Contractors must follow and adhere to ATF safety directives as well as site specific requirements. ATF policies that may affect the conduct of training are as follows:

    a. ATF O 3320.7 – Explosives Programs and Operations
    b. ATF O 3330.5 – Arson Enforcement Program
    c. ATF O 1630.1 – ATF Hazardous Exposure and Protection Program

11. Contractors must meet and adhere to current and future NCETR Standard Operating Procedures.

12. ATF will provide course lesson plans for all ATF-specific courses. ATF will also provide exercise guidelines and requirements for all Raven's Challenge sites. Any deviation from these plans or guidelines must be agreed upon in advance and in writing by the ATF program manager.

13. When applicable, instructors may be required to provide input, written updates, and/or revisions.

14. Contractor travel and per diem will be in accordance with Federal Government Travel Regulations.

15. NCETR program managers may expand on the listed minimum experience, education, and training requirements depending on the needs of the topic being taught.

16. When applicable, contractors may be required to physically demonstrate the skills being taught. Contractor skill levels must exceed minimum standards set for the students or exercise participants. Contractors may be asked to either provide documentation in advance to verify this requirement or the requirement may be validated through observation and evaluation by NCETR staff.

17. In order to continue to meet ATF requirements for currency of certifications and continuing education, contractors must submit evidence of additional training every two (2) years from date of award. Time spent serving as a contractor cannot be utilized to meet this requirement.

18. Training or exercise will occur at ATF provided facilities. ATF will provide all required materials and equipment unless specified otherwise in the assignment.

19. Contractors are expected to maintain an email address in order to receive information pursuant to their agreements. Contractors are to ensure that ATF is informed when email addresses change.

20. Agreements are awarded for the services of a specific individual whose qualifications have been vetted with ATF. Substitutions are not permitted.

3.1 Specific Contractor Qualification Criteria

Attachments 2-6 detail the recommended contractor qualifications required to support ATF and provides a detailed description of contractor qualifications by knowledge area. Generally, there are a limited number of contractors required for each program, and the topics usually require specific and advanced knowledge, training, experience, and education in a variety of topics related to ATF's mission. A separate proposal should be submitted for each CLIN being applied for.

CLIN	Specialty Area	Position	Attachment Number
0001	Explosives	Explosives Specialist - Law Enforcement/Industry Operations Instructor	2
0002	Fire/Arson	Fire and Arson Specialist – Law Enforcement Instructor/Program Technical Specialist	3
0003	Raven's Challenge	Raven's Challenge – Exercise Support Specialist	4
0004	Raven's Challenge	Raven's Challenge - Technical Operations Specialist	5
0005	Canine	NCD Academy Canine Trainer	6
0006	Canine	NORT Canine Trainer	7

4.0 ASSUMPTIONS AND CONSTRAINTS

4.1 Copyright Clause

Contractors may not utilize any materials or information provided by ATF (unless publicly available) including regulations, policies, directives, correspondence, standard operating procedures (SOPs), photographs or videos, or any classified, law enforcement sensitive, or confidential information for the purposes of any other production, contract or project. Any lesson plans, curriculum, agenda, photographs, videos or materials prepared by the contractor for ATF under this contract shall be deemed ATF proprietary data and as such is the sole property of the United States Government. The contractor may not copyright, resell, share, present, or transmit any materials or information provided to the Instructor by ATF without the prior written permission of ATF.

4.2 Expert Witness/Industry Consultant Clause

The contractor is prohibited from contracting to testify against ATF or any Federal governmental entity while contracted to provide goods or services to ATF under this or any other Department of Justice contract. Further, the contractor agrees that he/she is prohibited from testifying as an expert or contractual witness against ATF or any governmental entity on any matter that requires the contractor to rely upon or reference any lesson plans, curricula, or courses prepared by the contractor pursuant to this contract, or upon any materials or information provided to contractor by ATF, that is not otherwise publicly available. The contractor may not share or transmit to his or her agents, employee(s), employer(s) any of the aforementioned materials, information, lesson plans, curricula or courses for the purpose of testimony as an expert or contractual witness in any proceeding; administrative, civil or criminal.

Contractors generally are not prohibited from acting as consultants for industry Federal firearms licensees (FFLs), or Federal explosives licensees or permittees (FELs), lobbying groups, associations, or any private entity to assist with improving compliance with Federal laws and regulations. However, the contractor is prohibited from serving as a consultant or advisor, to industry FFLs, FELs, lobbying groups, associations, or any private entity on any matter related to any ATF adverse actions, to include administrative hearings, warning conferences, or revocation hearings while contracted to provide goods or services to ATF under this or any other Department of Justice contract.

4.3 Professional Insurance Coverage

Contractors are responsible for acquiring and maintaining their own professional insurance for all work provided in relation to this agreement. In the event of injuries as a result of participation in training, demonstrations, or other work provided under this agreement, contractors are not compensated by the ATF or the U.S. Department of Justice through workers compensation, employee insurance, automobile insurance, rental insurance, travel insurance, or any other similar mechanism. Further, any damage to any equipment or materials used or owned by the contractor employed in work conducted under this agreement is the responsibility of the

contractor. As the burden of responsibility regarding insurance coverage solely belongs to the contractor, the Bureau does not require proof of insurance for this agreement.

4.4 Background Investigation

All contractors are subject to a background investigation. Before an agreement can be placed by ATF, the contractor will be required to complete a personnel security package which includes forms SF 85P, Questionnaire for Public Trust Positions; ATF F 8620.26, Credit Release; ATF F 8620.27, Non-Disclosure Agreement; and questionnaires regarding drug use and financial declarations. The package also includes two fingerprint cards that must be completed and provided along with two passport type photos. BPAs will not be awarded without a completed successful adjudication. Failure to comply with requests for background investigations will result in immediate termination of the proposal/agreement.

Additionally, contractors are required to provide personal information electronically through the Department of Justice e-QIP on-line application. Contractors will receive a unique link into E-QIP via email, where they will be required to provide the requested information in the system. Contractors are to print out the specified signature pages from e-QIP and include the signed documents in the personnel security package when it is completed and returned.
Failure to complete e-QIP and submit the personnel security package in a timely manner may result in the immediate termination of the proposal/agreement.

4.5 Registration Requirements

A SAM registration is required for any entity to bid on and get paid for federal contracts or to receive federal funds. These include for profit businesses, nonprofits, government contractors, government subcontractors, state governments, and local municipalities. SAM.gov registration is available at US Federal Contractor Registration, www.usfcr.com. It is the responsibility of the contractor to have and maintain a SAM registration. Failure to have or maintain a SAM registration will result in immediate termination of the proposal/agreement.

4.6 Ordering and Invoicing Requirements

Ordering

When an ATF program manager identifies a need for a contractor, he/she will contact potential contractors to determine their availability. Typically, ATF provides a lead time of sixty (60) days. However, when a need to backfill a requirement or some other emergency requirement occurs, ATF may make contractor availability requests with much shorter lead times.

For routine requests, ATF will allow the contractor up to two (2) days from the time of request to respond affirmatively, before seeking a contractor from another source. For non-routine requests, the ATF Training Manager will determine the amount of available response time allowed on a case-by-case basis and provide this information to the contractor at the time of the request. No contractor will have recourse against ATF when situations dictate contractor scheduling outside

of the standard time frames for placing contractor calls.

Invoicing

Complete invoicing instructions will be included in the terms and conditions of the Blanket Purchase Agreement. However, ATF expects contractors to invoice upon completing the assigned course.

5.0 PROPOSAL

ATF's objective is to provide a sufficient number of contractors to ensure the success of ATF's mission. Therefore, ATF will have recurring open submission periods to receive and evaluate proposals for additional contractors. The following schedule depicts the current and anticipated solicitation, submissions and evaluation timeframes:

Proposal Submission Times:

BPA Year 1	November 16, 2026 – November 30, 2026
BPA Year 2	October 15, 2027 – October 31, 2027
BPA Year 3	October 15, 2028 – October 31, 2028
BPA Year 4	October 15, 2029 – October 31, 2029
BPA Year 5	October 15, 2030 – October 31, 2030
Proposals or requests for a BPA that are received by ATF outside the above-listed formal solicitation periods cannot be retained and considered, unless otherwise noted in the solicitation announcement.	

Note: Proposals are to be sent via email to Mr. James Huff, Contracting Officer to James.Huff@atf.gov. All submissions must be received by 5:00 PM (EST) on the closing date for the proposed submission time. Submissions received after that time or by FAX or mail will not be accepted.

The period of performance for the Base Year will begin on date of award. Each subsequent option year will begin on that same date of the following year. For example, if the award is December 1, 2025, the Base Year will begin December 1, 2025 and end November 30, 2026. Option year one would begin on December 1, 2026 and each subsequent Option Year would begin on December 1st.